Case Study 1 - Atari

Student submission

Assignment revision: 5 | Maximum points: 10 | Student: ict | Submitted: 2026-10-13T02:21:41.863Z | Submission revision: 310 | Receipt: v4r_01M4SH1KK7VWRJKNJ46CFJR684 | Exported: 2026-10-13T02:21:42.647Z

Worksheet link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/ict

Grading link

https://courses.ethereallab.app/assignment/v4/IT265-001-F2026/case-study-1-atari/grading/ict

AI disclosure: Completed; 1 entry; 0 declared AI use; 1 declared no AI use; policy v1

Game Overview

Game details

Response prompt

Identify the game: title, developer, publisher, original platform, genre, and release date. Note the version you played if different.

Submitted response

Title: Dig Dug
Developer: Namco
Publisher: Namco
Original Platform: Arcade Cabinet
Genre: Maze and Action / "Strategic Digging"
Release Date: 1982

History and industry

Response prompt

Explain the historical context of the release and where the game fit in the industry at that time.

Submitted response

Origin: After making Galaga and Pac-Man Namco wanted to make a more freeform maze game; one with action, but without premade pathing.

Contemporary comparison

Response prompt

Compare the game with a similar game from the same period, explaining a meaningful design similarity or difference.

Submitted response

Comparison: It features similar movement to Pac-Man, but allows the player to dig their own path in addition to making previously dug paths faster to traverse.

Gameplay Mechanics And Level Design

Core gameplay mechanics

Response prompt

Explain how the core actions and rules shape a recurring player decision. Support the explanation with a gameplay example.

Submitted response

Gameplay Loop: The game revolves around aggressive play and finding a way to kill all the enemies on the map. Every level generates with a set of enemies in small caves, in which the player needs to kill all but one of to progress

further.

Level design

Response prompt

Explain how the layout, obstacles, or progression affect a player decision or challenge. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

Level design: Enemies tend to move in their caves, but can move through walls after a while. In order to contest this, the player must make their own tunnels, which runs the risk of enemies chasing you through there. Enemies walk faster than they phase through walls, and they walk faster than the player can dig, but the player can walk faster than them through pre-dug tunnels. Additionally, the rocks in the terrain allow for routing to kill enemies that are trailing behind the player.

Graphic And Audio Design

Visual design

Response prompt

Explain how a visual design choice affects the experience or communicates information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

Visual design: One example of a visual design decision is the rocks showing movement before they fall; this not only warns the player to dodge, but helps the player gauge the time needed to bait enemies into its path for a kill.

Sound design

Response prompt

Explain how music, sound effects, or their absence affect the experience or communicate information during play. Use a specific example.

Submitted response

Sound design: The sound design is relatively simple; the music is a simple loop, and there's stingers for when events like dying/completing a stage happens. Notably, enemies make a sound when killed, allowing one to diverse their attention while maneuvering.

Narrative And Storytelling

Narrative and setting

Response prompt

Explain how the setting and story relate to play. Describe key events if present, or explain the effect of a limited or absent story.

Submitted response

Narrative and setting: There is no story, but the underground setting helps with contextualizing the making tunnels gimmick.

Character development

Response prompt

Explain how character development relates to gameplay, or how limited or absent development affects the experience.

Submitted response

Character development: There is also no character development; one might associate themselves as Dig-Dug himself but I doubt it would be benefictal for their sanitation.

Impact And Reception

Reception

Response prompt

Summarize the critical and player reception using identifiable reviews or feedback.
Distinguish release-era reception from later reactions.

Submitted response

Reception: It seems to be very good for its time; it has decent graphics, and innovative gameplay; as seen by a more recent review by "Retro Gaming Geek". This also held up during its release; reaching Japan's second-highest grossing arcade game in 1982.

Industry and cultural impact

Response prompt

Explain the game's industry impact and cultural significance using research. Avoid claiming influence that the sources do not establish.

Submitted response

Impact: The game had some impact in terms of inspiration, and inspired games such as Spelunky due to the setting and ideas relating to a manipulatable cave. Despite this, the impact was not that big.

Reflection

Fun and experience

Response prompt

Explain what made the game enjoyable or frustrating for you, using a gameplay example.

Submitted response

Fun and experience: I honestly had much more fun playing this game than I thought; I put in a solid ~3 hours playing trying to beat it before realizing there were 200+ levels. My favorite gimmick was using planning attacks with the rocks in order to get fun kills (I was not good at it).

Learning and research

Response prompt

Reflect on what this case study taught you and how easy or difficult it was to find dependable information.

Submitted response

What I learned: Older classics can be fun; maybe I don't need to only play Deadlock and new age Minesweeper. The information was also easy to find, as this game was big hit; if I had a less popular game I might have struggled.